

Archstone Renewal: Kickoff Notes

Vandelay Industries Legal Operations · September 4, 2026

VANDELAY INDUSTRIES, INC. · LEGAL OPERATIONS

Meeting notes: Archstone DMS renewal kickoff

Friday, September 4, 2026, 2:00 to 3:15 p.m. ET · 38th floor, Conference Room 38C and video

Prepared by: Theo Sinclair, Director, Legal Operations Distribution: attendees; Simon Rasmussen (GC); Roberto Salinas (CPO). Internal and confidential.

Attendees: Theo Sinclair (Legal Operations, chair); Sofia Pellegrini (Legal Technology); Lorenzo Fontaine (DMS Administration); Marcus Larsson (Records & Information Governance); Kwame Oyelaran (Training & Enablement); Ada Paredes (Paralegal Manager); Daniel Ellison (Contracts Manager); Esme Marchetti (DGC, Privacy & Data Protection, by video from London); Hannah Kirsch (Procurement, Vendor Management); Dana Whitlock (CISO office, by video); Julian Feld (CIO, first 20 minutes); Priya Raghunathan's office represented by Anil Desai (FP&A, Legal budget).

1. Why we are meeting now

Sofia reported that while preparing the integration register for the renewal she re-read Amendment No. 2 (January 2024) and found that Section 4 changed the notice period for non-renewal from 60 days to 120 days. Everyone in the room, including Theo, had been working from the 60-day figure in the 2018 agreement and Amendment No. 1.

The current term ends February 28, 2027. Under 120 days, written notice of non-renewal must be delivered by **Saturday, October 31, 2026**. Under the 60-day assumption the deadline would have been December 30. Today is September 4. We have 57 days, and Amendment No. 2 also set the renewal term at 36 months, so if no notice is given the agreement renews for three years at whatever price Archstone sets under Section 7.2 of the master.

Archstone's renewal proposal (received August 25) asks for \$59.50 per user per month, an 18.1 percent increase on our current rate, with Insight AI and Premium Support included, and says the price is valid until October 15. Nobody at Archstone mentioned the October 31 notice date.

Theo: "This is not a crisis. It is a compressed timeline. We have three years of data on this relationship and we are going to use all of it before we decide anything."

2. Positions in the room

Finance (Anil Desai, for the CFO). FY2027 guidance is flat year over year for the legal technology line. The current Archstone run rate is roughly \$147,000 a year. The proposal is \$171,000 in year one and about \$535,000 over three years. Any multi-year commitment above \$500,000 in aggregate requires Finance Committee approval; the committee meets October 22 and December 10. If Legal wants the October meeting, the paper is due October 15. Anil also asked why we are paying for 240 seats when the department has 230 people.

Corporate IT (Julian Feld, CIO). IT's direction is to consolidate on the Hooli Workspace suite where a module exists. Hooli Docs for Legal is available under the enterprise agreement at \$22 per user per month incremental. IT would fund migration professional services from the FY2027 transformation budget if Legal commits by the end of Q1 FY2027, and would want Legal on the enterprise renewal cycle (2028). Marcus acknowledged the two custom integrations are Legal's problem either way. Marcus left at 2:20 and asked Hooli to send Sofia an overview.

Procurement (Hannah Kirsch). Under the procurement policy any renewal above \$250,000 aggregate or with an increase above 10 percent requires a competitive check before signature. A rapid RFI to two alternatives with a ten-business-day response window is the minimum. Procurement has a template. Hannah also noted that Archstone's "valid until October 15" date is a sales device, not a contractual one; nothing in the agreement requires us to accept by then, though the price could go up.

Privacy (Esme Marchetti). Schedule C to the proposal would allow Archstone to use "de-identified" Vandelay content to train models offered to other customers. That is a material broadening from the Amendment No. 3 pilot terms, which were tenant-only, and it does not meet Standard 2.7. Esme will not sign off on Schedule C as drafted. She also noted that Insight AI is currently restricted to US, UK, and Ireland users under the pilot and asked what the proposal means for Singapore and Mexico City.

Information Security (Dana Whitlock). The most recent SOC 2 document on file is a bridge letter from February 2025. The ISO 27001 certificate expired in June 2025. Both were supposed to be delivered under Exhibit C. Dana's position: no renewal signature without a current SOC 2 Type II report and either a renewed ISO certificate or a dated recertification plan. Dana also wants the Cortexa Labs subprocessor assessed.

Records & IG (Marcus Larsson). The RetainIQ retention and legal hold integration depends on Archstone's folder metadata model. It took nine months to build. Any platform change means rebuilding it, and there are 14 active legal holds that cannot be interrupted.

Paralegals and Contracts (Ada Paredes, Daniel Ellison). The paralegal and contracts teams are in the system all day and, on the whole, like it. Ada: "Search got worse after the March incident and nobody has fixed it, and support takes days now where it used to take hours. But do not make my team learn a new system in the middle of the Brightwater arbitration." Daniel agreed and added that the contracts team's Inkwell eSign workflow runs through the DMS.

Training (Kwame Oyelaran). The July pulse survey shows training adequacy as the lowest-rated item department-wide, and the groups that rate the system lowest are the ones that use it least. New Joiner Orientation has not been offered since April 2025. Kwame's view: whatever we buy, enablement has to be in the deal, and of the 63 people who joined since the relaunch, 48 have no training record on the current version.

Legal Technology (Sofia Pellegrini, Lorenzo Fontaine). Ten licensed seats belong to people who have left. Deprovisioning is manual and has not kept up. Vandelay's own monitor recorded two months below 99.9 percent availability (November 2025 and March 2026); Archstone's Q2 review reports 99.95 percent for the trailing twelve months because Exhibit B measures annually. Mean first response from Archstone has gone from under two hours in 2024 to nearly seven hours this year. No service credits have ever been claimed.

General Counsel (relayed by Theo from a call that morning). Simon's instruction: "Do not break litigation. The paralegals come first. Beyond that, bring me a recommendation I can defend to Priya and to the board if it comes to that, and make sure Esme is comfortable with anything that touches our data."

3. Options on the table

Option	What it means	Who favors it
A. Renew as proposed	Accept Order Form No. 4 and Schedule C by October 15	Nobody in the room as drafted
B. Renegotiate from documented leverage	Renew with Archstone on terms that meet our standard: price at or near market, Schedule C rewritten to tenant-only, monthly SLA with automatic credits, current certifications as a condition, seat count right-sized, enablement bundled	Paralegals, Contracts, Records; Legal Technology if service terms improve
C. Rapid RFI, then decide	Issue a rapid RFI to Hooli and Pied Piper in parallel with negotiation; use the results either to switch or to negotiate B from strength; deliver notice of non-renewal by October 31 if we are not on terms	Procurement (required anyway), Finance, IT (for Hooli)
D. Short bridge renewal	Negotiate a 12-month extension at current pricing to buy time for the platform	Considered; Archstone has not offered it and the 36-month renewal term is in

Theo's summary: B and C are not alternatives. Procurement requires C, and C is what makes B work. The real decision is whether the RFI results are good enough to make switching the recommendation.

4. Decision calendar

Date	Event
Sep 4 (today)	Kickoff; data pull assigned
Sep 11	All data in one folder; scorecard against LO-STD-014 complete
Sep 14	Rapid RFI issued to Hooli and Pied Piper (10 business days)
Sep 18	Negotiation position sent to Archstone; request current SOC 2 report and ISO status in writing
Sep 28	RFI responses due
Oct 2	Options memo to GC
Oct 9	GC decision; Finance Committee paper drafted
Oct 15	Archstone "loyalty pricing" expiry (their date, not ours); Finance Committee paper due
Oct 22	Finance Committee
Oct 31	Notice of non-renewal deadline (Saturday; deliver by Friday Oct 30)
Nov 15	FY2027 budget lock
Dec 10	Finance Committee (fallback)
Feb 28, 2027	Current term ends

5. Actions

#	Action	Owner	Due
1	Assemble the complete contract set (MSA, Amendments 1 to 3, Exhibit C, proposal) in the renewal folder	Sofia	Sep 8
2	Pull 30 months of	Anil / Legal Ops e-	Sep 8

	invoices and reconcile seats billed against roster	billing analyst	
3	Export license list, usage telemetry, and support/SLA history	Lorenzo, Sofia	Sep 8
4	Export LMS attendance and package the July survey results	Kwame	Sep 8
5	Integration register with migration impact and rebuild estimate	Sofia	Sep 8
6	Northstar market brief, peer poll, and vendor overviews into the folder	Hannah	Sep 8
7	Score the contract set against LO-STD-014	Theo, Sofia	Sep 11
8	Draft rapid RFI from Procurement template	Hannah, Theo	Sep 11
9	Written request to Archstone for current SOC 2 report, ISO status, and Cortexa Labs security documentation	Dana, Sofia	Sep 8
10	Privacy redline of Schedule C	Esme	Sep 18
11	Deprovision the ten departed users; confirm with Archstone that October invoice reflects 230	Lorenzo	Sep 11
12	Draft notice of non-renewal letter, ready to send, held pending decision	Theo	Oct 2

Theo closed: "Everything goes in one folder. Nobody analyzes from memory."

End of notes.